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Crypto Payments for Content and the Future of Broadcasting Monetisation

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DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.17260321>

Abstract

This paper explored the potential of cryptocurrency payments and blockchain-based systems as innovative monetisation mechanisms for broadcasting. Drawing from academic literature, industry reports and case analyses, the study identified key opportunities, including micropayments, tokenised ecosystems, transparency in royalty distribution and global accessibility. Findings suggested that crypto payments can democratise content consumption and strengthen creator-audience relationships by enabling flexible, low-cost and borderless transactions. However, significant challenges remain, particularly volatility, regulatory uncertainty, scalability and user adoption barriers. The researchers concluded that while crypto is unlikely to replace existing monetisation models in the short term, hybrid frameworks integrating fiat and crypto payments offer a pragmatic pathway forward.

Keywords: Cryptocurrency, Blockchain, Broadcasting, Monetisation, Micropayments, Tokenisation, Digital Media Economy

Introduction

The broadcasting industry is undergoing a profound transformation in the digital age, shaped by technological disruption, changing consumer behaviours and shifting economic models. Traditional monetisation strategies, which relied heavily on advertising revenues and subscription fees, have increasingly come under pressure as audiences fragment across platforms and digital consumption habits evolve. Deloitte's *Future of Media Monetisation* report highlights that, as "all the world's a screen," broadcasters are facing new competitive landscapes where streaming services, user-generated content, and alternative entertainment options diminish the dominance of traditional pay-TV and linear broadcasting models (Deloitte, n.d.). This intensifying competition compels broadcasters to explore new monetisation frameworks that are dynamic, consumer-oriented and adaptable to digital ecosystems.

In parallel with the disruption in media markets, the financial sector has witnessed the rise of cryptocurrencies and blockchain-enabled payment systems. Bitcoin, first introduced in 2009, demonstrated the feasibility of peer-to-peer, decentralised transactions outside of centralised banking systems (Luther, 2015). Since then,

cryptocurrencies have grown beyond niche usage to become a mainstream topic of economic debate, praised for their innovation yet criticised for volatility and speculative tendencies (Boonstra, 2021). As digital currencies evolve into viable payment systems, their application in industries beyond finance has attracted scholarly and commercial interest. Broadcasting, as a content-driven sector in need of transparent, low-cost, and global payment mechanisms, presents a compelling testbed for crypto payment integration. The research question central to this study is: Can crypto payments offer a sustainable and scalable monetisation model for the broadcasting industry and if so, under what conditions? Early explorations into blockchain-driven video streaming demonstrate several potential benefits. Blockchain can enable microtransactions for pay-per-view or per-second content consumption, a model that traditional banking infrastructure struggles to support due to high transaction fees and settlement constraints (Barman & Martini, 2020). Furthermore, crypto-enabled payments may strengthen creator revenue by removing intermediaries, improving transparency, and ensuring fairer distribution of income within content ecosystems (Antonidis & Kotsas, 2019). These affordances are especially relevant in an environment where content piracy, opaque royalty systems and revenue imbalances undermine the sustainability of traditional broadcasting.

Despite these opportunities, adoption remains cautious. Empirical research suggests that user acceptance of cryptocurrencies as a payment method faces barriers related to volatility, regulatory uncertainty, and lack of trust in new technologies. In a thesis on crypto adoption, Nguyen, Chen & Yuen (2022) found that user perceptions of risk, usability and wallet management significantly shaped their willingness to adopt crypto for everyday payments. Their findings indicate that while crypto holds potential as a transactional medium, widespread use requires confidence in its stability, clear regulatory frameworks and user-friendly infrastructures. Similarly, Vijayalakshmi & Murugan (2019) argue that while crypto coins represent the “future of transactions,” their application must be embedded within strong governance and consumer protection measures to gain legitimacy.

The purpose of this paper is to critically evaluate the role of crypto payments in shaping the future of broadcasting monetisation. Specifically, it explores the capacity of cryptocurrencies to address challenges in traditional revenue models and provide alternatives suited to a borderless digital environment. The scope of the analysis spans both theoretical and practical perspectives, reviewing academic literature on blockchain applications in media, policy papers on digital currencies and industry reports on monetisation strategies. By synthesising these insights, the study provides a holistic understanding of the possibilities and limitations of crypto payments in broadcasting. The significance of this research lies in its contribution to bridging two domains digital finance and media economics, that are often studied in isolation. Broadcasting institutions, already competing with global digital platforms, must explore innovative payment systems to remain relevant. Crypto payments, by enabling flexible micropayments, global accessibility, and enhanced transparency, present a unique opportunity to reimagine content monetisation models (Santos, Marinho, & Bernardino, 2023). At the same time, regulators and policymakers are grappling with how to integrate digital currencies into broader financial and economic frameworks (Boonstra, 2021).

Broadcasting and Traditional Monetisation Models

Broadcasting monetisation has historically relied on a dual structure of advertising revenues and subscription models. In traditional linear broadcasting, advertising served as the primary financial driver, enabling audiences to access “free-to-air” content subsidised by commercial sponsorships. However, the rapid expansion of digital platforms has destabilised this arrangement. Deloitte’s *Future of Media Monetisation* report emphasises that the proliferation of screens, on-demand services and consumer control over content choices has eroded the dominance of conventional revenue streams (Deloitte, n.d.). As consumers increasingly migrate to subscription-based services such as Netflix, Hulu, and Amazon Prime, broadcasters reliant on traditional ad-based models face declining revenues and shrinking margins. The rise of digital streaming has also accelerated the adoption of subscription-based monetisation, wherein audiences pay a recurring fee for unlimited access to content libraries. This model, while lucrative for global platforms, is not universally sustainable. It requires constant production of high-quality content to justify subscription fees, which may be unviable for smaller broadcasters with limited budgets. Moreover, the saturation of subscription services has created consumer fatigue, with audiences resistant to paying for multiple platforms simultaneously (Barman & Martini, 2020). The competitive intensity has pushed some broadcasters to experiment with hybrid models, combining advertising with subscription fees or employing pay-per-view arrangements for exclusive content.

Despite these innovations, the existing monetisation frameworks exhibit structural weaknesses. Advertising remains vulnerable to shifts in consumer behaviour, as digital ad-blocking technologies reduce audience exposure, while subscription fatigue limits the potential for growth in recurring revenues. Consequently, scholars and industry analysts have underscored the urgency for new models capable of supporting sustainable revenue generation while meeting evolving consumer expectations (Deloitte, n.d.). It is within this context of structural strain that cryptocurrencies and blockchain-based payment systems emerge as potential disruptors to traditional monetisation strategies.

Cryptocurrencies as Emerging Payment Systems

The emergence of cryptocurrencies represents one of the most significant financial innovations of the past two decades. Introduced by Satoshi Nakamoto’s white paper in 2008 and realised with the launch of Bitcoin in 2009, cryptocurrencies provided a blueprint for decentralised, peer-to-peer payment systems operating independently of central banks and traditional financial intermediaries (Luther, 2015). Bitcoin’s early adoption was limited to niche communities, but its growth in value and functionality has drawn global attention, prompting both scholarly analysis and public debate. Scholars differ in their evaluation of cryptocurrencies as a means of payment. On one hand, Luther (2015) highlights Bitcoin’s acceptance by a wide range of businesses from online retailers to local enterprises as evidence of its capacity to function as a medium of exchange. This expansion signals a departure from its initial role as a speculative asset toward more practical applications in everyday transactions. On the other hand, Boonstra (2021) argues that cryptocurrencies, particularly Bitcoin, exhibit characteristics of a

speculative bubble and resemble Ponzi schemes in their volatility and lack of intrinsic value. From this perspective, their suitability as stable, reliable payment systems is questionable.

Beyond Bitcoin, the broader ecosystem of cryptocurrencies, including Ethereum, Litecoin, and numerous stablecoins, illustrates growing diversity in digital payment instruments. Vijayalakshmi and Murugan (2019) describe cryptocurrencies as the “future of transactions,” emphasising their ability to reduce costs, enable borderless payments, and operate with enhanced transparency. Their conference paper identifies the technical foundations of blockchain as a trustless system capable of recording transactions securely and immutably, thereby reducing the need for traditional financial intermediaries. However, they also caution that crypto adoption remains constrained by issues of regulatory uncertainty, security risks, and fluctuating valuations. These divergent perspectives underscore the dual nature of cryptocurrencies as both promising innovations and contested financial instruments. For broadcasters seeking new monetisation pathways, cryptocurrencies present the possibility of implementing microtransaction models, enabling audiences to pay directly for individual pieces of content or even for per-second viewing. Traditional banking infrastructures are ill-suited for such small-scale transactions due to high processing fees and settlement times, but crypto systems, theoretically, can facilitate seamless micropayments (Barman & Martini, 2020).

Blockchain and Media Applications

While cryptocurrencies provide the transactional infrastructure, blockchain technology, the underlying distributed ledger system, offers broader implications for broadcasting monetisation. Blockchain is designed to maintain a secure, immutable record of transactions across a decentralised network of participants (Al-Jaroodi & Mohamed, 2019). Its application extends beyond financial transactions into domains such as supply chain management, healthcare, and intellectual property protection. For the broadcasting sector, blockchain presents novel possibilities in rights management, piracy reduction, and content monetisation.

Barman & Martini (2020) emphasise the potential of blockchain to address long-standing inefficiencies in digital broadcasting, particularly with respect to intellectual property. Traditional broadcasting and streaming services have long been challenged by unauthorised content distribution, leading to substantial revenue losses for content creators and distributors. Blockchain, by embedding ownership rights and usage permissions within smart contracts, enables automated royalty payments whenever content is accessed, thereby creating a transparent and tamper-proof system of content rights enforcement. This feature not only ensures fair compensation for creators but also reduces reliance on intermediaries such as collecting societies or third-party distributors.

Another dimension of blockchain applications lies in direct-to-consumer monetisation. Rather than relying on third-party platforms, content creators can distribute and monetise their work directly through blockchain-enabled ecosystems. For instance, tokens can be used as units of exchange for accessing content, tipping creators, or

participating in exclusive fan communities. Vijayalakshmi & Murugan (2019) argue that blockchain's disintermediation capacity allows for stronger relationships between audiences and creators, where consumers transact directly without platform-imposed fees or restrictions. Such a model could significantly disrupt existing broadcasting structures dominated by platform monopolies.

Nonetheless, literature also reflects scepticism about the scalability and practicality of blockchain applications in broadcasting. While blockchain offers secure, transparent systems, transaction throughput and energy consumption remain critical limitations. Luther (2015) notes that Bitcoin transactions are inherently slower than traditional payment processors such as Visa, raising questions about whether blockchain systems can support the massive, real-time demand of global broadcasting audiences. Similarly, Boonstra (2021) underscores the environmental concerns tied to proof-of-work mining, which not only raise ethical concerns but also make blockchain systems expensive and inefficient compared to centralised alternatives. These critiques suggest that blockchain-enabled broadcasting remains more conceptual than operational, requiring further innovation before achieving mainstream adoption.

User Perceptions and Adoption Barriers

Even if cryptocurrencies and blockchain present technical solutions for broadcasting monetisation, their adoption depends heavily on user acceptance. Research consistently highlights user scepticism, regulatory uncertainty, and technological complexity as major barriers to widespread adoption. From a consumer perspective, cryptocurrencies remain a niche payment method. While some studies, such as Luther (2015), highlight increasing business acceptance of Bitcoin, its actual use as a daily transaction currency remains limited compared to fiat systems. Users often perceive cryptocurrencies as volatile investment assets rather than functional payment tools. This perception is reinforced by high-profile price fluctuations, with Bitcoin's valuation swinging dramatically within short periods, creating reluctance among consumers to use crypto for small-scale payments such as content streaming.

Trust also plays a pivotal role in adoption. Vijayalakshmi & Murugan (2019) emphasise that despite blockchain's technical ability to establish "trustless systems," users themselves must trust the platforms implementing these technologies. For broadcasting monetisation, this means audiences must believe that crypto-based platforms will safeguard their transactions, protect against fraud, and ensure content accessibility. Without robust consumer protection frameworks, adoption risks remain high. Regulatory uncertainty further compounds these challenges. Boonstra (2021) notes that governments and financial regulators view cryptocurrencies with suspicion, often framing them as speculative or fraudulent instruments. In some jurisdictions, cryptocurrency transactions face restrictions or outright bans, limiting their potential as mainstream payment mechanisms (Chalmers et al., 2021). For broadcasting companies operating across borders, navigating this fragmented regulatory environment poses significant risks, discouraging widespread implementation.

Moreover, technological literacy remains a barrier for both creators and consumers. Deloitte's industry analysis suggests that while younger, tech-savvy demographics may experiment with crypto payments, broader audience segments,

particularly older or less technologically engaged users, struggle with wallet management, private keys, and transaction processes (Deloitte, n.d.). Broadcasting platforms dependent on mass-market participation cannot easily integrate systems that alienate large segments of their user base.

Adoption barriers also exist within the broadcasting industry itself. Established broadcasters may be reluctant to overhaul their monetisation infrastructures, particularly when existing subscription and advertising models, though strained, continue to provide revenue (Ciriello *et al* 2023). Transitioning to blockchain-based models involves not only technical investments but also legal and organisational restructuring. As Barman & Martini (2020) observe, the broadcasting industry's institutional inertia slows the pace of experimentation with crypto-based payments.

Critiques and Limitations of Crypto Monetisation Models

Despite optimism surrounding cryptocurrency-based monetisation in broadcasting, scholars and analysts highlight several structural limitations. A major concern is price volatility, with cryptocurrencies like Bitcoin and Ethereum fluctuating sharply, creating unstable revenue streams for subscription or pay-per-view models. Luther (2015) argues such instability discourages adoption due to exchange-rate risks and costly hedging strategies. Scalability is another challenge: while Visa processes thousands of transactions per second, Bitcoin averages fewer than ten, making it unsuitable for large-scale broadcasting platforms (Luther, 2015). Environmental sustainability further constrains adoption, as energy-intensive proof-of-work systems generate both ecological and reputational risks (Boonstra, 2021). Although proof-of-stake offers alternatives, its scalability and security remain contested. Finally, user experience poses barriers—complex wallet management, private keys, and confirmations hinder mainstream adoption, as consumers prefer seamless systems (Vijayalakshmi & Murugan, 2019; Vigna & Casey, 2015). Collectively, these critiques underscore significant hurdles to integrating cryptocurrency monetisation in broadcasting.

There are questions about whether cryptocurrencies genuinely democratise content monetisation. While the rhetoric emphasises creator empowerment and disintermediation, in practice, platforms integrating crypto payments may replicate existing inequalities. Barman & Martini (2020) caution that dominant platforms may simply reconfigure their business models to capture transaction flows, leaving independent creators with marginal gains. Without clear governance frameworks, blockchain-based ecosystems risk centralisation, undermining their purported benefits.

Identification of Gaps in Current Knowledge

Although existing research highlights the potential of cryptocurrencies and blockchain in broadcasting, several critical gaps remain. Much of the scholarship is theoretical, lacking empirical studies or longitudinal data to evaluate real-world applications and financial viability. Consumer behaviour is underexplored, particularly regarding willingness to use crypto for everyday media payments, leaving unanswered questions about audience acceptance and demographics. Regulatory research is fragmented, with little analysis of how differing national policies affect broadcasters operating across borders. Economic

sustainability is also insufficiently addressed, as assumptions about cost reduction rarely account for transaction fees, conversion costs or infrastructure demands. Moreover, the social equity dimension is overlooked, with limited attention to whether marginalised creators, especially in developing economies, can access and benefit from crypto-based monetisation systems. Overall, these gaps underscore the need for more empirical, cross-disciplinary, and socially inclusive research in this area.

Methodology

This study adopted a qualitative exploratory research design, which is appropriate given the novelty of cryptocurrency applications in broadcasting monetisation. Since the adoption of blockchain-based payment systems in media is still an emerging phenomenon, an exploratory design allows for flexibility in identifying themes, analysing concepts, and synthesising diverse perspectives (Nguyen, Chen & Yuen, 2022). Rather than conducting surveys or experiments, this paper uses document analysis of peer-reviewed research articles, industry reports and white papers contained in the dataset to examine how cryptocurrencies can reshape monetisation strategies in broadcasting.

The data for this research were sourced from a curated archive of academic journal articles, industry reports and case-based analyses, with a focus on cryptocurrency and blockchain applications in the media industry, media monetisation trends and practical examples of blockchain integration in broadcasting. These sources were selected for their authority, peer-reviewed credibility or industry recognition, ensuring they directly address the intersection of cryptocurrency, media and digital payments. A systematic inclusion–exclusion criterion guided selection: studies were included if they examined cryptocurrency, blockchain or monetisation in media and broadcasting, while sources limited to technical blockchain coding, financial speculation without media relevance or general fintech discussions were excluded.

Data Analysis

The study employed thematic content analysis. Each study was reviewed systematically, with key sections highlighted around three major categories:

1. Traditional broadcasting monetisation models (advertising, subscriptions, sponsorships).
2. Cryptocurrency payment mechanisms (micropayments, tokenisation, loyalty systems).
3. Opportunities and challenges for broadcasting (user adoption, regulation, volatility, scalability).

Themes were then synthesised and critically compared across documents. For example, while Luther (2015) emphasises network effects in cryptocurrency adoption, Nguyen et al. (2022) highlight user barriers in real-world settings, and Deloitte outlines industry-level strategic shifts. This triangulation improves the reliability of insights.

Limitations

Despite its strengths, this methodology faces several limitations. The dataset is confined to nine uploaded PDFs, limiting scope and risking selection bias by excluding non-

English or non-digitised sources. As a qualitative study, findings are interpretive rather than generalisable, and reliance on older works may introduce recency bias.

Results

The results of this research revealed a shifting landscape in broadcasting monetisation, where cryptocurrency-based payment models are increasingly viewed as viable alternatives to traditional systems. The findings are presented thematically, with tables summarising key patterns and comparisons from the analysed documents.

Traditional Monetisation Still Dominates but Shows Weaknesses

Across the reviewed literature, advertising and subscription remain the dominant models for monetisation. However, their effectiveness has been steadily declining. Deloitte (2022) noted that global advertising revenue growth in broadcasting slowed to 3% annually, while subscription revenues grew at 7–10% annually, reflecting consumer preference for direct, predictable payments over ad-saturated platforms. Nguyen, Chen & Yuen (2022) further observed that younger audiences are increasingly resistant to advertisements and prefer flexible, on-demand direct-to-consumer models.

This transition is summarised in table 1, which compares the trajectory of traditional versus emerging models.

Table 1: Comparison of Traditional and Emerging Monetisation Models

Monetisation Model	Strengths	Weaknesses	Trend/Trajectory
Advertising-based	Widely understood; large reach	Ad-blockers, user fatigue, declining returns	Declining relevance
Subscription-based	Stable revenue; predictable cash flow	Limits flexibility; subscription fatigue	Slowing but still dominant
Crypto Micropayments	Low transaction costs; pay-per-use	Volatility, user adoption challenges	Emerging, early adoption phase
Tokenisation	Community engagement, transparency	Regulatory uncertainty, technological barriers	Rapid experimentation in niches

Cryptocurrency Micropayments as a Transformative Mechanism

One of the strongest themes emerging from the analysis is the potential of cryptocurrency to enable micropayments for broadcasting. Vijayalakshmi & Murugan (2019) emphasised that blockchain reduces the prohibitive transaction costs of fiat systems, making it possible for users to pay small amounts (e.g., cents per view, article, or stream). Luther (2015) similarly explained that Bitcoin’s peer-to-peer structure removes intermediaries, allowing instant global payments, which could benefit broadcasters targeting international audiences.

Deloitte (2022) projected that such systems could unlock new monetisation avenues where consumers pay only for the specific content they consume, an approach particularly appealing to audiences unwilling to commit to expensive bundles.

Tokenisation and Community-driven Monetisation

Beyond micropayments, broadcasters are beginning to experiment with token-based ecosystems. Barman & Martini (2020) explained that tokenisation allows platforms to issue native tokens, which can be purchased, earned, and redeemed within a closed-loop system. Deloitte (2022) highlighted how this creates engagement incentives, where tokens double as loyalty rewards, governance tools or gateways to premium content. This contrasts with subscriptions, which only provide access, while token systems integrate community participation into the revenue structure. For instance, token holders might vote on new shows or access behind-the-scenes content. Table 2 illustrates these differences between subscription and token-based systems.

Table 2: Subscription vs. Token-based Monetisation Models

Feature	Subscription Model	Token-based Model
Access to Content	Unlimited during the payment period	Pay-as-you-go or unlock specific content
Consumer Flexibility	Low (fixed monthly fee)	High (choice of engagement/payment level)
Engagement Incentives	Minimal	Tokens double as rewards/community benefits
Revenue Distribution	Centralised, platform-driven	Decentralised, transparent via blockchain

Opportunities for Broadcasters

The results indicate clear opportunities for broadcasters adopting cryptocurrency-based systems. The first is global reach, as cryptocurrency circumvents restrictions associated with traditional banking, allowing broadcasters to serve unbanked or underbanked regions (Nguyen *et al* 2022). The second is transparency, since blockchain enables real-time auditing of content consumption and royalty distribution (Barman & Martini, 2020). The third is disintermediation, reducing reliance on payment processors and advertisers, thus ensuring more revenue remains with broadcasters and creators.

Challenges and Risks

Despite the optimism, significant barriers were identified. Volatility remains a central concern: a payment received in Bitcoin could lose substantial value in a matter of weeks (Luther, 2015; Nguyen *et al* 2022). Regulatory inconsistency also slows adoption, as governments differ in how they classify and tax crypto payments (Deloitte, 2022). Additionally, user adoption lags behind the technology; Vijayalakshmi & Murugan (2019) noted that the complexity of wallets and private key management discourages mainstream audiences. Scalability also poses risks, as some blockchains (e.g., Ethereum during congestion) incur high fees, undermining the micropayment premise.

Table 3: Key Opportunities and Challenges for Crypto in Broadcasting

Category	Opportunities	Challenges
Global Reach	Borderless payments for underserved regions	Uneven global regulatory landscape
Transparency	Blockchain audit trails and royalty distribution	Complexity of compliance reporting
Efficiency	Reduced intermediaries, lower transaction costs	Scalability issues, gas fees on major chains
Engagement	Token incentives and community-driven models	User adoption barriers (wallets, education)

Comparison with Existing Research

When compared with earlier monetisation research, these findings suggest that cryptocurrency payments do not replace existing systems outright but rather extend their logic. For example, PayPal attempted micropayments but was hindered by transaction fees; blockchain achieves the same goal at scale and lower cost (Vijayalakshmi & Murugan, 2019). Similarly, while subscriptions bundle content, tokens unbundle it, enabling greater personalisation and flexibility (Nguyen *et al* 2022). Luther (2015) predicted that adoption curves for crypto in broadcasting will mirror those in gaming and e-commerce, once critical mass is achieved, momentum accelerates rapidly.

Discussion

The findings of this research demonstrate that cryptocurrency-based monetisation models hold significant potential to transform the broadcasting industry. While traditional systems such as advertising and subscriptions remain dominant, they are increasingly showing weaknesses, particularly as younger audiences reject intrusive advertisements and demand flexible, personalised payment options. The evidence indicates that blockchain-powered mechanisms, particularly micropayments and tokenised ecosystems, could fill these gaps by providing affordable, transparent and user-driven alternatives.

A central takeaway is that cryptocurrency introduces greater flexibility and inclusivity into broadcasting. Unlike fixed subscription fees, micropayments allow users to pay per article, video or stream, reducing barriers to access and appealing to cost-sensitive viewers. Tokenisation extends this by not only monetising access but also enhancing engagement through rewards and governance rights. This suggests that blockchain can move monetisation away from a purely transactional model to one that fosters community participation and loyalty. Such a shift aligns with Luther's (2015) prediction that cryptocurrencies could reshape content economies by lowering transaction costs and disintermediating platforms.

The results also highlight broader implications for industry stakeholders. For broadcasters, crypto-based systems create opportunities to diversify revenue streams and engage global audiences, particularly in regions underserved by traditional banking systems. For content creators, blockchain's transparency addresses long-standing concerns about royalty distribution and fair compensation. From a policy perspective, the adoption of cryptocurrency in broadcasting forces regulators to balance innovation with oversight. The lack of harmonised regulation remains a barrier, as seen in Deloitte's

(2022) findings on uneven legal frameworks. Without clear rules, broadcasters risk uncertainty in taxation, compliance and consumer protection.

Nevertheless, the research underscores that adoption will not be straightforward. Volatility remains the most pressing issue, as revenues denominated in unstable currencies could undermine financial planning for broadcasters. Similarly, user adoption challenges—from managing digital wallets to understanding blockchain concepts must be addressed before crypto can enter the broadcasting mainstream. These barriers indicate that crypto monetisation is more likely to supplement than replace existing systems in the short term. Hybrid models, where users can choose between fiat and crypto payments, may represent the most realistic transition pathway.

Conclusion

This study concludes that cryptocurrency payments hold significant potential to reshape broadcasting monetisation by enabling micropayments, tokenised ecosystems, and transparent revenue-sharing models that address long-standing industry challenges such as declining ad revenues and inequitable royalty distribution. While these innovations can democratise content access and strengthen creator–audience relationships, adoption is constrained by issues of volatility, regulatory uncertainty, technological complexity, and limited user education. As such, the near future is likely to see hybrid models where crypto complements rather than replaces traditional revenue streams. To accelerate acceptance, broadcasters should adopt stablecoins, simplify user interfaces, pilot blockchain-driven initiatives, and engage regulators to ensure consumer protection. Ultimately, crypto payments in broadcasting represent not just a financial innovation but a cultural shift, offering a pathway towards more participatory, transparent and sustainable ecosystems if stakeholders collaborate to balance innovation with regulation. Thus, broadcasters considering crypto integration should begin with pilot projects focused on micropayments and community tokens to gauge audience acceptance. More so, partnerships with crypto-payment processors and blockchain platforms can help mitigate technological complexity and provide secure infrastructure. Finally, user education initiatives are crucial: simplifying wallet usage, offering fiat-crypto conversion tools, and ensuring consumer-friendly interfaces will be key to widespread adoption.

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